

# JEONGSOO SUH

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## EDUCATION

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**Duke University**

Ph.D. in Economics

*Durham, NC, United States*

*2021 - 2026 (expected)*

**London School of Economics**

M.Sc. in Economics (*with Distinction*)

*London, United Kingdom*

*2019 - 2021*

**Korea University**

B.A. in Economics & B.S. in Financial Engineering (*with Great Honor*)

*Seoul, Republic of Korea*

*2013 - 2019*

## RESEARCH FIELDS

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Labor Economics, Health Economics, Public Economics

## JOB MARKET PAPER

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“Child Protection in Response to Public Health Crises: Evidence from the Opioid Epidemic (solo-authored)”

*Abstract:* This paper examines the impacts of the opioid epidemic on child maltreatment and how Child Protective Services (CPS) responded to the epidemic. I use the reformulation of OxyContin, a nationwide supply shock in prescription opioids that exacerbated the opioid epidemic, as a natural experiment. Leveraging variation in states’ and counties’ exposure to this intervention, I find that the opioid epidemic led to an increase in maltreatment allegations, suggesting a rise in the underlying maltreatment risk. Despite heightened risk, institutional responses did not scale protective actions accordingly, resulting in more cases where children were left at home but subsequently reinvestigated for maltreatment. Foster care placement rates remained unchanged and administrative expenditures per allegation declined, pointing to a limited systemic response. This study underscores the inter-generational consequences of the opioid epidemic and highlights how public health crises can weaken protective systems, particularly when institutions lack the flexibility or capacity to adapt.

*Presented at:* Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Conference, Canadian Economics Association (CEA) Annual Meeting, Western Economic Association International (WEAI) 100th Conference, Economics Graduate Student Conference, Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting, Korea-America Economic Association (KAEA) Job Market Conference, Duke University Labor/Public Seminar

## WORKING PAPER

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“Mechanism Reform for Task Allocation” (with E. Jason Baron, Richard Lombardo, Joseph Ryan, and Quitze Valenzuela-Stookey), *NBER Working Paper #32369*

*Abstract:* Reforming an existing system for allocating tasks among agents introduces additional political and institutional constraints relative to designing one in isolation. We develop a general mechanism-design framework for using data on agents’ performance to improve outcomes while ensuring that no agents are made worse off relative to the status quo. As an illustration, we apply our results to the assignment of Child Protective Services investigators to maltreatment cases. Simulations show the mechanism reduces false positives (unnecessary foster care placements) by up to 14% while also lowering false negatives (missed maltreatment cases) and overall placements.

## WORK IN PROGRESS

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“Effects of Controlling Prescription Opioids on Child Welfare”

*Abstract:* This paper examines the effects of Prescription Drug Monitoring Programs (PDMPs) on child maltreatment, distinguishing between two types that vary in policy intensity: modern and mandatory PDMPs. Leveraging the staggered rollout of PDMPs across states, I find that modern PDMPs, which are fully electronic and integrated into clinical workflows, did not yield statistically significant effects on maltreatment allegations. In contrast, mandatory PDMPs, which require prescribers to consult the database, led to an 18 percent increase in maltreatment allegations. These findings suggest that the unintended consequences of prescription opioid control policies can extend to child welfare, operating through their effects on parental behavior.

## AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND FELLOWSHIPS

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**Program for Advanced Research in the Social Sciences Fellowship** *2025 - 2026*  
Interdisciplinary fellowship awarded to one economics PhD student per year, Duke University

**Merit-based Bonus for Head Teaching Assistant** *Spring 2023*  
\$2000 bonus awarded to outstanding head teaching assistants, Duke University

**Graduate School Summer Research Fellowship** *2022 - 2023*  
Duke University

**Economics Department Graduate Fellowship** *2021 - 2022*  
Duke University

**Great Honor** *2019*  
Equivalent to Summa Cum Laude, Korea University

**Semester High Honors** *2013 - 2014, 2016 - 2018*  
Awarded based on Semester GPA, Korea University

**Merit-based Honors Scholarships** *2013 - 2014*  
Awarded based on Semester GPA, Korea University

## TEACHING EXPERIENCES

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**Certificate in College Teaching** *2026 (expected)*  
Formal, documented training in college teaching, with official transcript record, Duke University

**Instructor** *Summer 2024*  
Econometrics and Data Science (Undergraduate), Duke University

**Head Teaching Assistant** *Fall 2022, Spring 2023*  
Statistical Foundations of Econometrics and Data Science (Undergraduate), Duke University

**Department-Sponsored Tutor** *Fall 2022*  
Tutored Economics Ph.D. student in the first-year core Econometrics course, Duke University

## CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

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**2025:** Canadian Economics Association (CEA) Annual Meeting, Western Economic Association International (WEAI) 100th Conference, Economics Graduate Student Conference, Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting, Korea-America Economic Association (KAEA) Job Market Conference, Duke University Labor/Public Seminar

**2024:** Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Conference, Duke University Labor/Public Seminar

**2023:** Duke University Labor/Public Seminar

## SERVICE

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**Co-Organizer, Labor/Public Economics Seminar, Duke University**     *Fall 2024, Spring 2025*

## OTHER EXPERIENCE

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**Military Service**     *October 2014 - July 2016*  
Served as a Korean Augmentation To the United States Army (KATUSA)

## SKILLS

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|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Computer Skills</b> | Stata, R, Python, Matlab, L <sup>A</sup> T <sub>E</sub> X |
| <b>Languages</b>       | Korean (Native), English (Fluent)                         |